# THE BIG BIO BOOST

**THE EXPANSION IN INDIA'S BIOFUEL MARKET IS AIMED AT COMPLETE ENERGY INDEPENDENCE IN THE FUTURE**

**Renewable sources of energy** have been getting a leg-up the world over as several countries look to replace fossil fuels with sustainable energy sources. The International Energy Agency has forecast that global oil demand will go up by 5.9 million barrels per day by 2028. Biofuels such as ethanol and biodiesel will provide 10 per cent growth in liquid fuel supply by 2028.

## WHY IT IS A GAME CHANGER

In India, the market for ethanol and biofuels has been growing at a significant rate, with the government promoting and utilising these green and clean fuels to the maximum extent.

Biofuels are fuels that are derived from biomass—plant, algae material or animal waste. They are sources of renewable energy and are promoted as a cost-effective and environment-friendly alternative to fossil fuels. Bio-ethanol, which is the most common biofuel, is ethyl alcohol that has been made from biomass. Another prominent biofuel is biodiesel, produced from edible oil (such as soybean or palm oils).

DEBAJYOTI CHAKRABORTY



**THE LIQUID POWER** An Emami Agrotech biodiesel plant at Haldia, West Bengal